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Christianity has therefore come as a general liberalizing influence—freeing the whole of that part of society which accepts it from all ritual observances and fears which characterized the old order, and substituting new fears—fears of sin and hell-fire and the devil. The new definition of what is socially wrong and bad does not take in the old definitions. It is based on an altogether new ideology and whatever of the old remains is modified and made to suit the new conditions and situations. Again, we must make the qualification that where the father-in-law and mother-in-law are old and were converts into Christianity—which means that they grew up under the old traditional regime—there is much friction between parents-in-law and the new daughters-in-law.

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We have not dealt anywhere in this analysis with other categories of affinal relatives, such as son's wife's brother or daughter's husband's sister. All there are, however, secondary and tertiary in their nature. They are all placed according to the generation in which they belong and are behaved to according to their relationships to the principal parties. If they are closely related to the son's wife or daughter's husband, then they are given a special place of regard, if not affection. But the important thing in all the secondary

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and tertiary relationships is the personality of the person concerned. In primary relationships the situation is much too closely structured for personalities to play a decisive role, but in secondary and tertiary relationships they do play a decisive role. Thus a wife's brother who was heir in the wife's patrilineal kin but an impossible drunkard was treated with scant respect among the Mngadi people in the Nyuswa area while a younger brother, who was educated and more regular in his habits, was accorded a high place in his brother-in-law's house.

Among the *abalamu*, i.e. brothers-in-law and sisters-in-law, there is an easy familiarity and joking relationship which marks them as potential spouses. At a gathering among the Qadi, a young man was talking to a group of girls and making quite a lot of verbal play on the word *lala*, i.e. to sleep, which can also mean sexual intercourse; and an interested person immediately remarked: "Obviously you are *abalamu* since this fellow is so fond of verbal play on the word *lala*." Young men pay their female *abalamu* much amorous attention which often ripens into marriage. This is considered the proper thing to happen, for the *abalamu* family is already known through their sister who is a wife in the boy's kinship group and either a good or a bad advertisement for all the girls of her patrikin. Being good, among the traditionalists, means being industrious, to *hlonipha* according to expectation, to be generous and, generally, always "to know my people", i.e. to be concerned about them when they come home and to give them food and drink.

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Among the Christians, however, the general pattern of *abalamu* has been very much modified by Christian teachings. The general attitude among Christians is to regard my wife's sister, not as a possible wife or substitute for her sister, but as my sister within the forbidden degree of marriage. Thus, although the terminology used is still *umlamu* and *sibali* (from Afrikaans "swaer"), the behaviour pattern between them resembles in some cases that between elder brother and younger sister. I have seen brothers- and sisters-in-law among Christians avoiding, in their conversation, anything that got anywhere near love affairs, just as happens between uterine brothers and sisters; and I have seen brothers-in-law reprimanding their sisters-in-law for having gone about with their lovers in their presence. People among Christians have expressed shocked surprise at the rumour of a sister-in-law having been intimate with a brother-in-law whereas traditionally it would be something to be expected.

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